

Flight Deck Notes // B787 SFTD 1 & 2

High-yield two-host study episode. Hosts: Tom (American), Jess (NZ first officer). Source: SFTD 1 & 2 decks, vetted vs FCOM/FOM. Verify all numbers in current manuals. Voice tags are ready for a studio TTS render.

JESS (NZ, FO): Welcome back to Flight Deck Notes, the B787 study podcast. I'm Jess.

TOM (US, host): And I'm Tom. Today we're doing the systems FTD sessions, S-F-T-D one and two, Days five and six. We're hitting the high-yield questions the instructors actually pull you on.

JESS (NZ, FO): Let's start cold and dark. You push the battery switch. What happens, and how long does it take?

TOM (US, host): On battery alone, the left common core router, the left C-C-R, comes online in about two to three minutes. At first only the captain's inboard display and the standby instrument, the I-S-F-D, light up.

JESS (NZ, FO): And here's the trap on the right C-C-R.

TOM (US, host): Right. The right C-C-R won't even start its cycle until two things are true: the left C-C-R has finished starting, and you have a power source other than the battery. So A-P-U or external power. People forget it needs both.

JESS (NZ, FO): Quick recall. The flight deck emergency equipment mnemonic?

TOM (US, host): F-F-L-A-A-P-O-D. Flashlights, two. Fire extinguisher, one. Life vests, four. AVSAX and gloves, one. Crash axe, one. P-B-E, one. Oxygen masks, four. Descent devices, four.

JESS (NZ, FO): Now the limits they love to disguise as airport scenarios. Max runway slope, max tailwind, and max takeoff and landing altitude?

TOM (US, host): Slope is plus or minus two percent. Tailwind, fifteen knots. Altitude, fourteen thousand feet. So the airport at fourteen thousand four hundred is a no, and the slope at four point six is a no.

JESS (NZ, FO): HF radios while refueling?

TOM (US, host): Do not operate them. Hard no.

JESS (NZ, FO): The R-T-O question. When does it command maximum braking?

TOM (US, host): Three conditions, and all three are required: on the ground, groundspeed above eighty-five knots, and both thrust levers at idle.

JESS (NZ, FO): R-A-T auto-deploy, give me the gist, and the A-P-U fire bottle delay.

TOM (US, host): The ram air turbine auto-deploys for things like both engines failed or all three hydraulic systems low, loss of all electrical power to the pilots' flight instruments, or loss of all four electric motor pumps with an engine failure on takeoff or landing. And on an A-P-U fire, it shuts down immediately, then the extinguisher fires after a fifteen-second delay to let the fuel valve close.

JESS (NZ, FO): Engine thrust rating, and passenger oxygen duration, two favorites.

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- TOM (US, host):** The GENx-1B is rated seventy-four thousand one hundred pounds of takeoff thrust each. And passenger oxygen lasts about twenty-two minutes, not ten to twenty. That ten-to-twenty wording is a classic false. The masks drop before the cabin reaches the greater of fourteen thousand five hundred, origin plus fifteen hundred, or destination plus fifteen hundred.
- JESS (NZ, FO):** Onto S-F-T-D two. Autoland wind limits, and the autopilot disconnect height?
- TOM (US, host):** Autoland: headwind twenty-five, tailwind fifteen, crosswind twenty-five. Cat two-three drops the crosswind to fifteen. And without LAND 2 or LAND 3 annunciated, disconnect the autopilot below one hundred thirty-five feet A-G-L.
- JESS (NZ, FO):** FLCH on final, takeoff flight control mode, and max flaps altitude?
- TOM (US, host):** Don't use FLCH below a thousand feet A-F-E. Takeoff is permitted in normal mode only, not secondary, not direct. That's a false-statement trap. And max altitude with flaps extended is twenty thousand feet.
- JESS (NZ, FO):** The glideslope attitude stabilizing mode, and the autothrottle retard height in the flare.
- TOM (US, host):** The stabilizing mode limits descent to three point two five degrees and uses inertial data for up to fifteen seconds. The slide says twenty-five to bait you. It's fifteen. And in the flare the autothrottle retards between twenty-five and fifty feet radio altitude.
- JESS (NZ, FO):** E-I-C-A-S. Which messages can't be canceled, and what's the rectangle icon?
- TOM (US, host):** Warnings, communications, and memos cannot be canceled with cancel-recall. Cautions and advisories can. And a rectangle icon means the message has procedural steps. Quick one on the checklist: closed loop items watch a switch and check themselves when it's correct. Open loop items need you to manually confirm.
- JESS (NZ, FO):** Walk the F-M-C failure ladder.
- TOM (US, host):** Three F-M-Cs: master, spare, backup. A single failure isn't even apparent, no action, LNAV and VNAV stay active. A dual failure gives you a SINGLE F-M-C advisory and the third takes over. A triple failure gives you an F-M-C advisory. You lose the map displays, C-D-U pages, and LNAV and VNAV, but autothrottles and autopilot pitch and roll still work, and you can fly a single lat-long waypoint off the tuning control panels.
- JESS (NZ, FO):** And the S-V exam itself?
- TOM (US, host):** One hundred questions, three hours, open book, eighty percent to pass, plus the memory items quiz.
- JESS (NZ, FO):** That's the high-yield set. Drill the limits cold, watch the false-statement traps, and you'll be ready.
- TOM (US, host):** Run it back on the portal games. See you in the sim.